



SAHARA DESERT

Much of northwestern Africa is covered by the scorching sand and rocks of the Sahara Desert. The world's largest desert, the Sahara is expanding at an alarming rate as the land at its edges is overgrazed and gradually turned to dust. Despite daytime temperatures of up to 122°F (50°C), freezing nights, and years on end without rain, the desert is home to some amazing animals, adapted to survive the conditions.



The fennec fox's huge ears let heat escape from its body, cooling it down.

The Tuareg ride on camelback, although motorcycles and four-wheel-drive trucks are increasingly used.



DESERT PEOPLES

Few people can survive in the harsh environment of the Sahara Desert. The hardy Tuareg are desert nomads who may travel vast distances a day, carrying salt to trade in markets. Traditionally, the Tuareg use camels for transportation and also to provide milk, meat, and hides. However, many Tuareg are now abandoning their centuries-old nomadic lifestyle and settling in cities.

